

Retention of WIC Records and Reports

Policy: Local WIC programs shall retain WIC records for the time period indicated.

Regulation: 7 CFR 246.25 (a)

Procedure/Additional Guidance:

The following list summarizes WIC's policies on retention of records and reports. Local health agencies may have local policies that require a longer retention period.

REPORT/RECORD	KEEP FOR
Agency Budget	6 years
Agency Contract	6 years
Caseload Management Work Sheets	At agency discretion
Compass User Access Verification Reports	3 ½ years*
Grocer complaint forms	3 ½ years*
Mandatory reports	5 years (or longer based on agency requirements)
Nutrition Education Plan	2 years*
Receipts	6 years
Retailer Orientation Reports	3 ½ years
Retailer Monitoring Reports	6 years
Secure Compass User ID Forms/Compass Access Request Form	3 ½ years*
Staff meeting minutes	At agency discretion
Time Certification	6 years
Ward Road Pharmacy/Sentido Health special formula signed invoices	3 ½ years*
WIC client records	5 years (per Compass parameter)

For any records not specifically called out in the table above, record retention is 3 ½ years.

*Years should be counted from the end of the applicable fiscal year. Example: Secure Compass User ID forms with any date between October 2018 and September 2019 (FY 2019) should be kept at least through March 2023.

Alteration of WIC Records

- Do not alter WIC records.
- Correct paper records by crossing out the errors and initialing them. Never use correction fluid (white-out). This policy protects WIC staff should participant records be subpoenaed in legal actions or in audits.